Tiffany M. Simon

CONTACT INFORMATION

Middle East Initiative, Harvard Kennedy School, One Brattle Square, Cambridge, MA
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APPOINTMENTS

Harvard Kennedy School 2025–present
Research Fellow, Middle East Initiative, Belfer Center

Princeton University Spring 2025
Postgraduate Research Associate, Department of Politics

EDUCATION

Princeton University 2025
M.A., Ph.D. in Politics
Fields: Comparative Politics, Middle East Politics, Formal and Quantitative Methods
Committee: Amaney Jamal, Grigore Pop-Eleches, Elizabeth Nugent, Rory Truex

Columbia University 2015
M.P.A., School of International and Public Affairs
Concentration: Economic and Political Development
Specialization: Advanced Policy and Economic Analysis and Management
Capstone: "The Impact of a World Food Programme Funding Shortfall on Syrian Refugees in Jordan"

University of California, Los Angeles 2006
B.A., Economics and Political Science
Minor: Middle East and North Africa Studies
Academic year abroad at the American University in Cairo, 2003–2004

RESEARCH

Bread and Circuses: The Political Consequences of Entertainment in Autocracies (job market paper)

Happiness and Political Control: Winning Compliance in the Arab Gulf (book project)

"Can you hear me now?": Experimental Evidence on Improving Public Service Delivery through Non-electoral Citizen Participation (with Asim Khwaja and Saher Asad)

Who Participates? Gendered Selection into Community-Based Collective Action (with Asim Khwaja, Saher Asad, and Hamna Tariq)

The Comfort of Capacity: How Exposure to Strong Governance Shapes Political Behavior (with Perry Carter)

Experiencing the Digital State: E-Government in the UAE (with Tarek Masoud)

Moral Education and Political Socialization in the UAE (with Tarek Masoud)

TEACHING

Brown University, Watson School of International and Public Affairs
Adjunct Lecturer, Applications of International Development (with Adam Levine), Spring 2027 (scheduled)

Princeton University, Department of Politics
Preceptor, Experimental Political Science (graduate, with Saad Gulzar), Spring 2024
Preceptor, Political Economy of Development (undergraduate, with Atul Kohli), Spring 2021
Preceptor, Quantitative Analysis I, Politics 571 (graduate, with Rocío Titiunik), Fall 2020

Columbia University, School of International and Public Affairs
Teaching Assistant, Governance and Public Sector Management in Developing Countries (graduate, with Barbara Nunberg), Fall 2014

GRANTS

"Can you hear me now?": Experimental evidence on improving public service delivery through non-electoral citizen participation, with Asim Khwaja and Saher Asad
Data and Research in Education Research Consortium ($120,000) 2025

International Growth Centre (GBP 69,664) 2024

J-PAL Governance Initiative ($274,922) 2022

J-PAL Governance Initiative, Pilot Grant ($51,865) 2019

J-PAL Governance Initiative, Proposal Development Grant ($10,000) 2019

Princeton University (internal)

Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies Graduate Research Award ($2,500) Winter 2022

Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice Dissertation/Pre-Dissertation Grant ($4,995) Fall 2022

Multi-Center Graduate Grant in Politics ($15,000) Spring 2021

Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice Dissertation/Pre-Dissertation Grant ($4,950) Spring 2021

Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies Language Study Grant, Lebanon ($1,600) 2019

Department of Near Eastern Studies Language Study Grant, Lebanon ($1,600) 2019

AWARDS AND HONORS

George Kateb Preceptor Award, Princeton University 2022

Prize Fellowship in the Social Sciences, Princeton University 2021–2022

POLICY WRITING

"Better Information Provision and Parent Involvement May Provide a Pathway for Improvements in Learning Quality in Pakistan" (with Asim Khwaja). *Annual Status of Education Report 2019*, ASER Pakistan. 2020.

"The Analytical Angle: Taking an Experimental Approach on Civil Service Reform" (with Asim Khwaja). *Dawn.* 2019.

"Designing Incentive Structures in Bureaucracies" (with Adnan Khan and Asim Khwaja) in Michael Kugelman and Ishrat Husain, eds., *Pakistan's Institutions: We Know They Matter, But How Can They Work Better?*, pp. 97–108. Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars. 2018.

"Policy Formulation and Implementation as a Design Challenge" (with Vestal McIntyre). *Evidence for Policy Design Policy Brief.* June 2017.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Beaj Education Foundation 2026–present
President, Board of Directors

Evidence for Policy Design (EPoD) 2015–2018
Senior Research Manager, Harvard Kennedy School

Office of the New York City Comptroller 2014
Summer Associate, Diversity Bureau

United Nations Office at Geneva and UNCTAD 2010–2013
Staff Assistant

Mossawa Center 2006–2009
Brussels Desk Officer and International Advocacy Intern

SERVICE

Columbia Journal of International Affairs 2014–2015
Online Managing Editor

SKILLS

Programming: **R**, Python, Stata, LaTeX, Qualtrics
Languages: Arabic (proficient), French (proficient), German (proficient)